

CANDY DIALOGUE ENGINE

Player Choices Part 2

1.1.0

This guide provides information about the `$Choice_Status` and `$Choice_Timers` commands, which are used for modifying choices and timers inside opened choice lists.

Before reading this guide, please read the [Player Choices 1](#) guide.

One important thing to keep in mind: both commands don't actually change the dialogue itself.

Instead, when the dialogue engine processes a `$Choice_List` command, it duplicates it in the `choice_list_data` array in `Candy_Engine.gd`. The `$Choice_Status` and `$Choice_Timers` commands modify the data in that array (and in the choice button instances).

If you want to make permanent alterations to a `$Choice_List` command inside a dialogue, you will need to use the `$Set` command, or write a function that you can call with the `$Call` command.

`$Choice_Status` Command

The `$Choice_Status` command lets you change various properties of the choices in a choice list that is displayed on screen.

Specifically, it can change whether a choice is enabled, active or visible, as well as a choice's label and tooltip.

Targeting

The command first requires that you indicate a method for targeting choice lists/menus, categories, and choices themselves. For each, three options are available:

Menus:

Last → Targets the last opened Choice Menu.

Tags → Targets Choice Menus that have the specified tags.

All → Targets all opened Choice Menus.

Categories:

Among the Categories inside the targeted Menus...

Last → Targets the last opened Category.

Tags → Targets Categories that have the specified tags.

All → Targets all opened Menus.

Choices:

Among the Choices inside targeted Categories...

Last → Targets the last selected Choice.

Tags → Targets Choices that have the specified tags.

All → Targets all Choices.

Some examples:

If you select 'Last' for all three, only the last selected choice will be targeted by the command: i.e. the command will target the last menu, the last opened category in that menu, and the last selected choice in that category.

If you select Menu = Last, Category = Last, and Choice = All, all choices in the last menu and category will be modified by the command.

For precise targeting, you can assign tags to menus, categories and choices (see the [Player Choices 1](#) guide).

Status Changes

The command offers four options to modify the Enabled, Active and Invisible statuses of choices:

"-" → Don't change the status, whatever it is.

Enable/Activate/Show → Set the status to Enabled/Activated/Visible.

Disable/Deactivate/Hide → Set the status to Disabled/Inactive/Invisible.

Toggle → Change the status to its current opposite, whatever it is.

Title and Tooltip Changes

You can type a new title or tooltip you want targeted choices to display.

If you don't want to change the title and tooltip, leave the Title and Tooltip input fields empty.

Effects

To use the `§Choice_Status` command correctly, it's important to understand how it operates.

1. The command first creates a list of all menus and categories it must target.
2. Then, for each targeted category, iterates through its choices to find those it must target. For each such choice, the command changes its statuses, title and tooltip as specified inside the `choice_list_data` array and in the choice button instance.
3. If a choice was previously enabled, and the command is configured to disable it, the command calls and awaits the `_toggle_enabled()` function of the choice. The command then deletes the button.
4. If a choice was previously disabled, and the command is configured to enable it, the choice's Setup transition is performed. After that, a button for that choice is created in the correct menu and category. Note that the `setup()` function of the choice is called, which calls `_toggle_enabled()`, `_toggle_active()`, `_toggle_invisible()`, `_set_label()` and `_set_tooltip()`.
5. If a choice was neither enabled or disabled by the command, steps 3 and 4 above are skipped; the command calls `_toggle_active()`, `_toggle_invisible()`, `_set_label()` and `_set_tooltip()` on the choice, if their corresponding values were modified (e.g. `_toggle_active()` is only called if the command modified the choice's Active status).

Note that if you use the `§Choice_Status` command to enable a choice, it should be safe to also include `§Choice_Status` in that choice's Setup transition. However, while Candy DE is in pre-release, we recommend careful testing as a precaution.

The command is also designed to avoid unnecessarily modifying choices. For example, if the command is configured to enable choices, and some choices are already enabled, the command won't create an extra button for those choices. Likewise, if the command is set to make a choice Active, but the choice is already Active, the command won't call `_toggle_active()` as if the active status had just changed.

Usage

The `§Choice_Status` command is great for modifying choices at Setup or after they've been selected (or to make selected choices or timers modify other choices). However, as with all commands, you will need to think about the logic in how you use it within dialogues, to avoid unintended effects.

For example, if a choice is disabled, keep in mind that no button will be created for it until a `§Choice_Status` command enables the choice.

It's all mostly straightforward, but using the command correctly can get more complex if you try to do complex things with it.

§Timer_Status Command

The §Timer_Status command can be used to modify timers in opened §Choice_List menus, including previously nested menus.

Targeting

The §Timer_Status command targets Choice Menus and Timers, in the same way that the §Choice_Status command targets Choice Menus and Choices. For Timers, if 'Last' is selected as the targeting mode, the last timer to have reached 0 will be selected.

Changes

The §Timer_Status command can modify the countdown time of timers and their number of loops (how many times they count down). Leave the Time or Loop fields empty if you don't want to modify those values.

- To set the time or loop to a specific value, type the value (e.g. '4').
- To modify the time or loop by a relative value, prefix the value with '+', '-', '*' or '/' (e.g. '+3' to add 3 to the current value).

IMPORTANT: '-1' will decrement loops by 1, it will not set loops to infinite.

- To set loops to infinite, type either 'inf', '!' or '0'.

You can also indicate whether timers should be immediately updated to adjust to the new time (if the time was modified):

Restart → Reset the timer from the new Time. For example, if the timer's countdown had reached 3 seconds, and the command set the Time to 10, the timer will reset at 10.

Update → The timer will only update its countdown Time if the Time is changed to a lower value. For example, if the timer's countdown had reached 7 seconds, and the command set the Time to 2, the timer will change to 2; however, if the timer's countdown had reached 7 seconds, and the command set the Time to 10, the timer will not reset at 10.

Ignore → The timer will keep its current Time for the current loop, but it will reset to the new Time for subsequent loops. To clarify, this is true even when the timer is stopped/not started, not just when the timer pauses.

Finally, the command can also be configured to (re)start, pause or stop the timers it targets. Select "-" if you want the timer to keep its current status, whatever it is.